

Tabloid TECH

People And Events That Grabbed Headlines—For Better Or For Worse

Preference for Pink



Melanie Griffith: I want pink—now!

Sales associates at the four Apple retail stores in the Los Angeles area have plenty of opportunities to rub elbows with Hollywood celebrities. And it turns out isn't always pleasant.

Hollywood actress Melanie Griffith, according to one associate, threw a tantrum when she was unable to buy a pink iPod mini early last year.

The associate, who asked to remain anonymous, said Griffith came right up to him and "pretty much demanded" a pink iPod mini. The mini was in short supply, and the associate told her there were none in stock.

He told *Wired* News, "She then proceeded to get pissed off at me personally because we didn't have any in stock. She said we have a special stock of iPods for people like her.... I hadn't seen any celebrities there up until

then, so at first I was like, 'Oh wow, cool, Melanie Griffith.' But then she opened her mouth and used me as a doormat."

Other celebrities who have indulged in pompous, obnoxious or cheap behaviour at Apple's LA stores include singer Pink, and actors LeVar Burton Val Kilmer and Fred Durst.

So It Was You?

A Jordanian recently divorced his wife after discovering that she was also his virtual girlfriend.

Bakr Melhem had been flirting with a woman on an Internet chat room for several months before the two decided to meet. When they finally met at a bus station in Zarqa near Amman, he recognised her to be his wife Sanaa!

The wife had described herself as an unmarried Muslim lady whose cultural interests included reading.

Bakr Melhem immediately shouted the Arabic words for 'I divorce you' thrice. Jordanian news agency, *Petra*, reports when the man uttered the words that effectively ended their marriage, she called him "a liar" before fainting.

Sleeptexting!

Britain is a nation of prolific texters, as we reported earlier. As a sort of 'proof' of this, it has emerged that a man in Swansea, Wales, sends text messages in his sleep—a sign of the times, according to a sleep expert.

Richard Griffiths, 23, has sent a series of messages while asleep—one even mirroring a nightmare he was having.

He said: "I text so much it's second nature. But I was still freaked out." He once sent a text message to his friend

Ashley Jones saying: "Help, I'm in trouble, someone's chasing me." She immediately rang back, and found that he had been only dreaming and was not in trouble.

Another text, referring to the film *Jungle Book* he had seen, read: "Baloo, have you seen Bagheera?"

Sleep expert, Professor Chris Idzikowski, said: "I have not heard of this before, but it is entirely plausible—and possibly a sign of the modern age."

'Cybersex' Takes On New Meaning

Kim Jong-Hwan, director of IRRC (Intelligent Robot Research Centre) in South Korea, plans to give the gift of sex to robots. He has developed a series of artificial chromosomes, which, he claims, will allow robots to "feel lusty." It could eventually lead to them reproducing, reported *Free Internet Press*, the news portal.

OK, so it's all about software in the end. Jong-Hwan said the software would, amongst other things, give the machines the ability to "feel, reason and desire."

"We must consider this as the origin of an artificial species. Until now, most researchers in this field have

focused only on the functionality of the machines, but we think in terms of the essence of the creatures," said Jong-Hwan, a leading authority on the technology and ethics of robotics. According to him, the 'essence' is a computer code modelled on human DNA.

"Robots will have their own personalities and emotions, and as films like 'I Robot' warn, that could be very dangerous for humanity. If we can provide a robot with good, soft chromosomes, they may not be such a threat," Jong-Hwan said.

We are not very clear on what "good, soft chromosomes" means—but let's wait and watch.

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